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Standard Operating Procedure: Teledyne-Webb APEX Deployment

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Last revised: October 10, 2026

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1. Plain Language Summary

APEX floats are pressure activated and light enough to be deployed by hand, making the deployment relatively straightforward. Remove the float from the crate, remove and plugs/caps from sensors, and deploy. Suggested deployment method is by hand by attaching a rope to the ship, slipping it through the hole in the white metal collar on the float, and lowering it into the water, slipping the line out. In rough weather, it may be best to use a crane to gain more separation between the float and the ship.

Deployment should be done while the ship is underway (1-2 kts) to help the float get clear of the ship and avoid any collision.

Send deployment log to Chris Gordon via email or WhatsApp. Thank you!

2. Contact

Email: chris.gordon@dfo-mpo.gc.ca (work); chris.gordon.93@gmail.com (personal)

Cell/WhatsApp: +1 (902) 237-1135

I try to be as best available as I can during and leading up to deployments. If possible, giving a heads up on the likely timzing of a deployment is appreciated, but I understand that schedules often change at sea. Email and WhatsApp are the best forms of communication, and for anything urgent please include my personal email as I am more likely to see it if I am away from my computer or outside of work hours. Nothing is too small of a question please do not hesitate to get in touch; we all want to ensure a successful and safe deployment!

3. Preparation

1. Remove the float from the crate and remove any plugs. For a core float, this will just be the 3-piece plug on the SeaBird sensor, or no plugs for an RBR sensor.

4. Deployment

2. Remember during deployment that the number one priority is safety. Always wear proper PPE and appropriate floatation gear. Make sure that the science staff, deck crew, and bridge are all aware of and satisfied with the deployment plan.
3. Ask the bridge to have the ship underway, steaming 1-2 kts to help the float get clear of the ship upon deployment. If deploying at a station, strongly suggest this is the final operation on station (i.e. deploy as you are leaving station).
4. Using a slip-line through the white metal collar on the float, APEX floats can be deployed by hand. Attach the line to the ship at one end, and slip the other through the collar, ensuring you have enough length to lower the float all the way to the sea surface.
5. Lift the float over the side (2 people), lower into the water, and release.
6. Record the time (UTC) and position.
7. The float will not sink immediately – keep an eye on it as it gets clear of the ship.

DO NOT LEAVE ANYTHING ATTACHED TO THE FLOAT (ROPE, LOOP, etc.)

5. Deployment Notification

Once the float has been deployed, please email chris.gordon@dfo-mpo.gc.ca within 24 hours with the deployment metadata and any additional information/comment. A logsheet similar to the example below should have been provided.

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Argo Deployment Log Sheet

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Mission: Atlantic Zone Monitoring Program (AZMP)
Dates: October 7-26, 2026
Ship: RRS Discovery
Cruise Number: DY216
Chief Scientist: Lindsay Beazley
Argo Contact: Chris Gordon, chris.gordon@dfo-mpo.gc.ca, +1 (902) 237-1135

WMO	Serial Number	Nominal Station	Actual Station	Date	Deployment Time (UTC)	Event Number	Latitude	Longitude	Plugs/Caps Removed	Magnet Removed	Deployed By
4902748	P5389B-26CA003	HL_07									
4902749	P5389B-26CA004	HL_07									